

Absolutely — **less** is a very useful grammar/polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “In a way, it feels **less** like a picture and more like a window” opening onto a calmer world.”

Here **less** means **to a smaller degree / not as much**, specifically in the comparison:

> **less** like A, more like B

> = **比較不像 A，而更像 B**

Grammar family: **less / least / lesser**

Base form: less

Superlative: least

Related adjective: lesser

Part of speech: determiner (限定詞) / pronoun (代名詞) / adverb (副詞) / adjective-like comparative form (比較形式)

Unlike a word such as **paint**, **less** is mainly a grammar/polyfunctionality target.

Meaning in your passage: **less + adjective/preposition phrase = 程度較低；比較不.....**

Your sentence:

> “It feels **less** like a picture and more like a window...”

Here **less like** means:

> **not as much like / resembling something to a smaller degree**

繁體中文：

與某事物的相似程度較低；比較不像.....

Natural translation:

> “It feels less like a picture and more like a window...”

「它給人的感覺**比較不像一幅畫，反而更像一扇窗**.....」

So here:

> **less** like A, more like B = 與 A 相似程度較低，而與 B 相似程度較高

1. **less + uncountable noun = 較少的.....**

This is one of the core uses.

Practice 1

> “The room needs **less light**.”

「這個房間需要**較少的光線**。」

Practice 2

> “She uses less sugar now.”

「她現在用**較少的糖**。」

less + uncountable noun = 數量較少

Common:

* less water

* less money

* less time

* less noise

2. **less = a smaller amount — 較少；少一些**

Here it stands alone as a pronoun.

Practice 3

> “I expected more, but I got **less**.”

「我本來以為會得到更多，結果卻得到**較少**。」

Practice 4

> “Try to spend less.”

「盡量**少花一點**。」

less = 較少的數量 / 程度

3. **less + adjective = 比較不.....；較不.....**

A major adverb use.

Practice 5

> “The second room is **less crowded**.”

「第二個房間**比較不擁擠**。」

Practice 6

> “This version feels less formal.”

「這個版本感覺**沒那麼正式**。」

less + adjective = 某種性質的程度較低

So:

> less expensive

> = 較便宜 / 沒那麼貴

> less obvious

> = 沒那麼明顯

4. **less + adverb = 較不.....地**

Practice 7

> “He spoke **less confidently** this time.”

「他這次說話**沒有那麼有自信**。」

Practice 8

> “The machine runs less efficiently when overloaded.”

「機器超載時運作得**較沒有效率**。」

less + adverb = 某個動作方式 / 程度較低

5. **less like + noun = 比較不像.....**

This is your exact source pattern.

Practice 9 — Original

> “It feels **less like a picture** and more like a window.”

「它給人的感覺**比較不像一幅畫**，反而更像一扇窗。」

Practice 10

> “The room feels less like an office and more like a home.”

「這個房間感覺**不像辦公室那麼多，反而更像家**。」

More natural Chinese:

「這個房間**比較不像辦公室，反而更像家**。」

less like X = 與 X 相似的程度較低

6. **less ... than ... = 比.....少 / 較不.....**

A core comparative structure.

Practice 11

> “This painting is **less dramatic than** the other one.”

「這幅畫**沒有另一幅那麼戲劇化**。」

Practice 12

> “She spends less time online than before.”

「她現在花在網上的時間**比以前少**。」

less A than B = A 的數量 / 程度低於 B

7. **less and less = 越來越少；越來越不.....**

A major progressive comparison.

Practice 13

> “I use my phone **less and less**.”

「我用手機用得**越來越少**。」

Practice 14

> “The colours became less and less visible.”

「那些顏色變得**越來越不明顯**。」

less and less = 數量或程度持續下降

8. **no less than + number = 足足；不少於**

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 15

> “The museum owns **no less than** fifty paintings by the artist.”

「博物館收藏了**足足五十幅**這位畫家的作品。」

Practice 16

> “The repair cost no less than ten thousand dollars.”

「維修費用**足足高達一萬元**。」

no less than + number = 數量多到值得強調；足足有.....

Important:

this can express **surprisingly large quantity**.

9. **no less + adjective/adverb = 同樣.....；絲毫不遜色**

Practice 17

> “The second painting is ****no less beautiful****.”

「第二幅畫****同樣美麗 / 一點也不遜色****。」

Practice 18

> “Her later work is no less important.”

「她後期的作品****同樣重要****。」

****no less + adjective = 並沒有比較少；同樣具有某種性質****

10. ****not less than + number = 不少於；至少****

This is different from ****no less than**** in tone.

Practice 19

> “The room can hold ****not less than**** fifty people.”

「這個房間可容納****不少於五十人****。」

Practice 20

> “Applicants must have not less than two years of experience.”

「申請人必須具有****不少於兩年****的經驗。」

****not less than = 數量不能低於某個最低標準****

Very formal.

11. ****more or less = 大致上；差不多****

A very common expression.

Practice 21

> “The work is ****more or less**** finished.”

「工作****大致上 / 差不多****完成了。」

Practice 22

> “The two versions are more or less the same.”

「兩個版本**大致相同**。」

more or less = 大約；基本上；差不多

This does not mean literally “more or less quantity” in many contexts.

12. **much less = 更不用說；更何況**

A major formal/logical expression.

Practice 23

> “I can’t afford a reproduction, **much less** the original.”

「我連複製品都買不起，**更不用說**原作了。」

Practice 24

> “He can barely walk, much less run.”

「他連走路都很勉強，**更別說**跑步了。」

much less = 前一件事已經做不到，後一件更難 / 更不可能

Excellent MCQ material.

13. **still less = 更不用說；更何況**

More formal/literary than **much less**.

Practice 25

> “He cannot afford the frame, **still less** the painting.”

「他連畫框都買不起，**更不用說**那幅畫了。」

Practice 26

> “She had no time to rest, still less to travel.”

「她連休息的時間都沒有，**更不用說**旅行了。」

still less = 更不用說；尤其不可能

Register: formal/literary.

14. **less than + number = 少於；不足**

A core numerical use.

Practice 27

> “The walk takes **less than** ten minutes.”

「步行需時**少於十分鐘**。」

Practice 28

> “The ticket costs less than fifty dollars.”

「門票價格**低於五十元**。」

less than + number = 數量低於某個數值

15. **less than + adjective/noun phrase = 遠非；談不上.....**

A figurative intensifying use.

Practice 29

> “His explanation was **less than clear**.”

「他的解釋**一點也不清楚 / 相當不清楚**。」

Practice 30

> “The service was less than satisfactory.”

「服務**遠稱不上令人滿意**。」

****less than + positive adjective = 以較委婉方式表示明顯不足****

Often understated/critical.

16. ****nothing less than = 簡直就是；無異於****

A strong emphatic expression.

Practice 31

> “The view was ****nothing less than spectacular****.”

「那景色****簡直壯觀極了****。」

Practice 32

> “Her recovery was nothing less than remarkable.”

「她的康復情況****簡直令人驚嘆****。」

****nothing less than = 完全可以說是；程度非常強烈****

Often positive, but can be negative too:

> nothing less than a disaster

> = 簡直是一場災難

17. ****any less = 再少一點；程度再低一點****

Practice 33

> “I couldn’t care ****any less****.”

「我真的****一點都不在乎****。」

Practice 34

> “The room could not be any less welcoming.”

「這個房間簡直****一點也不讓人感到舒服 / 親切****。」

****any less = 程度進一步降低；常用於否定結構作強調****

18. ****less of + noun = 較少成分 / 較不像某種人事物****

A useful construction.

Practice 35

> “The redesign makes it ****less of a distraction****.”

「重新設計後，它****沒那麼容易令人分心****。」

Practice 36

> “He is less of a critic now.”

「他現在****沒以前那麼像個批評者 / 沒那麼愛批評****。」

****less of a/an + noun = 某種身分、特徵或作用的程度較低****

19. ****the less..., the more... = 越少.....，越.....****

A correlative comparative pattern.

Practice 37

> “The ****less**** you rush, the more you notice.”

「你****越不急****，就會留意到****越多****細節。」

Practice 38

> “The less light there is, the softer the room feels.”

「光線****越少****，房間感覺就越柔和。」

****the less X, the more Y = X 程度越低，Y 的程度越高 / 有所變化****

20. ****lesser = 較小的；較次要的；較不重要的****

A related adjective, but not interchangeable with **less** everywhere.

Practice 39

> “They focused on the **lesser** details later.”

「他們後來才處理那些**較次要的細節**。」

Practice 40

> “The lesser problem can wait.”

「那個**較不重要的問題**可以稍後處理。」

lesser = 在重要性、程度、地位等方面較低的

Often formal.

21. **the lesser of two evils** = 兩害相權取其輕

A common fixed expression.

Practice 41

> “They chose what they considered **the lesser of two evils**.”

「他們選擇了自己認為**兩害之中較輕的一個**。」

Practice 42

> “Neither option was good, so we chose the lesser of two evils.”

「兩個選項都不好，所以我們只能**兩害相權取其輕**。」

the lesser of two evils = 兩個不理想選擇中相對較不壞的一個

22. **least** = 最少；最不.....

The superlative counterpart.

Practice 43

> “This option costs the ****least****.”

「這個選項花費****最少****。」

Practice 44

> “It is the least obvious detail in the painting.”

「這是畫中****最不明顯****的細節。」

****least = 數量或程度最低****

23. ****at least = 至少****

A very high-frequency expression.

Practice 45

> “I would like ****at least**** a reproduction.”

「我****至少****想要一幅複製畫。」

Practice 46

> “Stay for at least an hour.”

「至少留一個小時。」

****at least = 不低於某個最低數量 / 程度；至少****

Your passage actually contains:

> “or ****at least**** a large, high-quality reproduction of it.”

So this family appears twice in the Monet passage:

* ****at least****

* ****less like... more like...****

24. ****at least = anyway / looking at the positive side — 至少；起碼****

A discourse use.

Practice 47

> “The original is too expensive, but **at least** I can buy a reproduction.”

「原作太貴了，不過**至少**我還可以買複製畫。」

Practice 48

> “It rained all day, but at least we enjoyed the museum.”

「整天下雨，不過**起碼**我們很享受博物館之行。」

at least = 即使其他方面不理想，仍指出一個較正面 / 可接受的事實

25. **not in the least** = 一點也不；完全不

A useful emphatic expression.

Practice 49

> “I’m **not in the least** surprised.”

「我**一點也不**驚訝。」

Practice 50

> “The room did not feel cold in the least.”

「這個房間**完全不**覺得冷。」

not in the least = 完全沒有某種程度；一點也不

Register: somewhat formal.

Important distinction: **less vs fewer**

This is the biggest learner contrast.

less

normally with uncountable nouns:

- > less water
- > less time
- > less money

fewer

normally with plural countable nouns:

- > fewer paintings
- > fewer visitors
- > fewer mistakes

So:

- > less water = 較少的水
- > fewer bottles = 較少的瓶子

Important nuance: **less + countable measurements**

English commonly uses **less** with measurements treated as a total quantity:

- > less than ten kilometres
- > less than five years
- > less than twenty dollars

Even though *kilometres/years/dollars* are countable, the phrase treats them as an amount.

Important distinction: **less vs little**

little

= not much; small amount.

less

= smaller amount compared with something else.

- > little time
- > = 時間很少

- > less time

> = 較少時間

So **less** is comparative.

Important distinction: **less vs least**

less

comparative:

= 較少 / 較不

least

superlative:

= 最少 / 最不

> less expensive

> = 較便宜

> least expensive

> = 最便宜

Important distinction: **less vs lesser**

less

usually determines amount or modifies degree.

> less money

> less serious

lesser

usually adjective meaning lower in importance, degree, rank, etc.

> a lesser concern

> = 較次要的問題

Not normally:

> **lesser money** ❌

Important distinction: ****less like A, more like B****

This is especially important for your source.

The pattern does not mean:

> “A little bit like A and a lot like B”

in a strict measurable sense.

It means:

> ****the better way to understand/describe it is B rather than A****

Example:

> “It feels less like a job and more like a hobby.”

= 「感覺與其說是工作，不如說更像興趣。」

For your sentence:

> less like a picture, more like a window

Natural Chinese can therefore be:

> ****「與其說它像一幅畫，不如說更像一扇窗。」****

This is probably the most elegant translation.

Important distinction: ****less than vs no less than****

****less than 50****

= 少於 50

****no less than 50****

= 足足 50 / 不少於 50，而且帶強調

Very different.

Important distinction: ****not less than vs no less than****

****not less than 50****

= 至少 50 ; 最低不能少於 50
formal/minimum threshold

****no less than 50****

= 足足 50
often expresses surprise/emphasis

Example:

> Applicants need not less than five years' experience.
> = 至少五年

> He owns no less than fifty paintings.
> = 他足足有五十幅畫

Important distinction: ****less than satisfactory****

This is often ****stronger**** than it looks.

> "The result was less than satisfactory."

Usually means:

> 「結果不太令人滿意 / 很不理想。」

It is often polite understatement, not merely mathematically "slightly below satisfactory."

Important distinction: ****much less vs even less****

****even less****

= 數量 / 程度更少

> "I have even less time today."

= 我今天時間更少。

much less

can literally mean “far less”:

> “This one costs much less.”

= 這個便宜很多。

But in:

> “I can’t buy the reproduction, much less the original.”

it means:

> **更不用說**

Context matters.

Important distinction: **less and less vs fewer and fewer**

Uncountable/degree:

> less and less time

> = 越來越少時間

Plural countable:

> fewer and fewer visitors

> = 越來越少訪客

Important grammar contrast.

Important distinction: **at least — minimum vs consolation**

Minimum:

> “Stay at least two hours.”

= 至少兩小時。

Positive consolation:

> “At least we tried.”

= 起碼我們試過了。

Same phrase, different discourse function.

Grammar/family sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **less + uncountable noun** = 較少
- * **less — pronoun** = 較少的量
- * **less + adjective/adverb** = 較不 / 沒那麼
- * **less like** = 比較不像
- * **less ... than ...** = 比.....少 / 沒那麼.....
- * **less and less** = 越來越少 / 越來越不
- * **less than + number** = 少於
- * **less than + positive adjective** = 遠非 / 談不上.....
- * **no less than** = 足足 / 不少於 (帶強調)
- * **not less than** = 不少於 / 至少
- * **no less + adjective** = 同樣..... / 絲毫不遜色
- * **more or less** = 大致上 / 差不多
- * **much less** = 更不用說
- * **still less** = 更不用說 (較正式)
- * **nothing less than** = 簡直就是
- * **any less** = 再少一點 / 再低一點
- * **less of a/an** = 較不像 / 較少具有某種性質
- * **the less..., the more...** = 越少....., 越.....
- * **lesser** = 較次要 / 較低等的
- * **least** = 最少 / 最不
- * **at least — minimum** = 至少
- * **at least — discourse** = 起碼 / 無論如何至少
- * **not in the least** = 一點也不

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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less + uncountable noun	與另一數量相比，某不可數事物的量較少
less — pronoun	較少的數量 / 程度

less + adjective/adverb	某種性質、狀態或動作方式的程度較低	
less like + noun	與某人 / 某物相似的程度較低；比較不像	
less ... than ...	數量或程度低於另一對象	
less and less	數量 / 程度持續減少	
less than + number	數量低於指定數值	
less than + adjective	委婉表示某性質明顯不足；談不上.....	
no less than	以驚訝 / 強調語氣表示數量多達.....；足足	
not less than	正式表示最低不能少於某數量；至少	
no less + adjective	某性質程度並不較低；同樣.....	
more or less	大致上；差不多	
much less	前項尚且不可能，後項更不用說	
nothing less than	強調某人 / 某物完全可以說是.....	
lesser	在重要性、程度或地位上較低的	
least	在三者或以上比較中數量 / 程度最低	
at least — minimum	不低於某最低數量 / 程度	
at least — discourse	在其他情況不理想時指出一項仍可接受的事實	
not in the least	完全沒有某種程度；一點也不	

For your original sentence

> “In a way, it feels ****less like a picture and more like a window**** opening onto a calmer world.”

The exact meaning is:

****less like a picture** = 它給人的感覺並不太像一幅普通畫作；相比之下，更像一扇通往另一個寧靜世界的窗******

The most natural translation is:

> ****「某程度上，與其說它像一幅畫，不如說更像一扇通往更寧靜世界的窗。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****less water**** → 較少的水
- > ****less dramatic**** → 沒那麼戲劇化
- > ****less like a picture**** → 比較不像一幅畫
- > ****less than \$100**** → 少於 100 元
- > ****no less than 100**** → 足足 100
- > ****not less than 100**** → 不少於 / 至少 100
- > ****more or less**** → 大致上 / 差不多
- > ****much less**** → 更不用說
- > ****less and less**** → 越來越少
- > ****lesser**** → 較次要的
- > ****least**** → 最少 / 最不
- > ****at least**** → 至少 / 起碼